

Log of the ship Martha, 1844-1855

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Remarks on Board Sunde [SUNDAY] the Sept the 8 - 1844
Commences [COMMENSES] with strong winds from the SE
heading S by W at 4 pm [BENT?] a [???]
top sail and [OF?]
Latter part at 7 am had light winds [???]
Over cast wether [WEATHER] maid sail and [OFF?]
[LOW?] ends with the captain quite [UN?] well
Latt [LATTITUDE] by obs [OBSERVATION] 31" 51 [S?] long [LONGITUDE] by
[DECK] 86" 47 W

Remarks on board mond [MONDAY] sept the 9 - 1844

Commences [COMMENSES] with light winds from the [???]
with [SEVERE?] wether [WEATHER] at mad tacked ship head
E W E at [???] past heading N [S?] tacked ship
heading S [???] W at 9 pm had the wind from
the SS [???] heading to the S and West
latter part at [???] am tacked ship heading to
the E N E at 7 am in [???] in [???]
new rigging at 8 am tacked ship heading S by W
[LOOK?] ends with over cast [OVERCAST] wether [WEATHER]
Latt [LATTITUDE] by Deck 32 " 15 S long [LONGITUDE] by deck 87 " [???] W

Remarks on board tuesd [TUESDAY] Sept the 10 - 1844

Commences [COMMENSES] with a gale in [???] in ships
Duty at 6pm had a light breas [BREEZE] from the
South steering E S E and [???]
Latter part had light winds and gales
at 5 am saw a spirm [SPERM] whail [WHALE] board the
boats and took chase but did not get
near him at [???] lost sight of him [SOMEHOW?]

with the boats [???] latt [LATITUDE] by obs [OBSERVATION] S W " 16 S
long [LONGITUDE] by [???] 86 " 25 W

Remarks on board Wedns [WEDNESDAY] Sept the 11 - 1844
Commences [COMMENCES] with fine wether [WEATHER] with the boats
of [OFF] in chase of a whail [WHALE] lost sight of him at 1
pm came on board got the [???] the whail [WHALE]
at 2 pm board the boats but he was going quick to
the S W and did not get near him at 6 pm [??]
on board shortened sail [??] to the wind heading S [??]
at 7 [??] watches latter part at [??] am more
ship heading N by W at 7 am stear E of E with
a gail of wind. latt [LATITUDE] by obs [OBSERVATION] 32 " 57 S
long [LONGITUDE] by obs [OBSERVATION] 85 " 39 W

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3

Remarks [REMARKS] on board Wedns [WEDNESDAY] Sept [SEPTEMBER] the
18 - 1844. Commences [COMMENCES] with thick and rainey [RAINY] [??] with
the head yards a back heading WSE [??] waiting for to clear up for the Captain
wished me to try to get [??] for him at [??] [??] a [??] at [??] from [??] now.
Chanse and the Capt [CAPTAIN] wished me to [??] lead on for [ZELPORASO]
Low [??]. Steared [STEERED] of SWE at 9pm had the wind from the SWE heading
N by W and [??] and [??] it 8pm had it calm and rainey [RAINY] at 10pm had a
light breas [BREEZE] from the SE stearing [STEERING] SWE latter part at 2am
[??] fell of to NE at 7am had a strong breas [BREEZE] [LOW?] ends latt
[LATITUDE] by Ob [OBSERVATION] 32 " 25 S long [LONGITUDE] by Ch
[CHRONOMETER] 77 " 51 [W?].

Remarks [REMARKS] on board Thursd [THURSDAY] Sept [SEPTEMBER] the 19
- 1840. Commences [COMMENCES] with light wind from the SE at 1pm had it calm
at 4pm on [??] and a [FAIR?] top sail and [??] latter part at 2pm had a light breas
[BREEZE] of wind from the ENE. Wore ship heading S by E at 7pm had a [??]
heading SE by E with thik [THICK] and overcast wether [WEATHER][??] [END?]
latt by [DECK?] 32 " 35 S lond [LONGITUDE] by [DECK?] 77 " 04 W.

Remarks [REMARKS] on board Frid [FRIDAY] Sept [SEPTEMBER] the 20 - 1844.
Commences [COMMENCES] with light wind from the North stearing [STEERING] E
by S at 3pm had it calm and [??] at 9pm had a light breas {BREEZE} from the N by
E stearing [STEERING] E by S latter part at 7 had the wind from the N by W [??]

the fore top most steering [STEERING] sail and if [LOW?] ends with the Captain quite un well [UNWELL]

latt [LATITUDE] by obs [OBSERVATION] by 33 " 30 E

long [LONGITUDE] by Ch [CHRONOMETER] 75 " 30 W

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5

Remarks [REMARKS] on board Sun [SUNDAY] Oct [OCTOBER] the 10 - 1844.

Commences [COMMENCES] with strong winds from the SE steering [STEERING] by the wind heading SW by S latter part had strong winds low and latt [LATITUDE] by Obs [OBSERVATION] 34 " 36 S long [LONGITUDE] by Ch [CHRONOMETER] 79 " 03 [???].

Remarks [REMARKS] on board Mond [MONDAY] Oct [OCTOBER] the 14 - 1844

Commences [COMMENCES] with strong winds from the SSE heading SW by S at 6pm under dubble {DOUBLE} [DRAFT?] top sails. latter part in [???] Im [I'm] [MENDING?] sail [???] ends.

latt by Obs [OBSERVATION] 35 " 20 S long [LONGITUDE] by Ch [CHRONOMETER] 81 " 10 W.

Remarks [REMARKS] on board Tuesd [TUESDAY] Oct [OCTOBER] the 15 - 1844

Commences [COMMENCES] with strong winds from teh SSE heading SW by S in [???] in [BENDING?] stay sails and [???] latter part [???] moderate winds at 6am maid [MADE] all sail heading W by S in [???] in [MENDING?] the spanker [???] ends. latt [LATITUDE] by Obs [OBSERVATION] 35 " 31 S long [LONGITUDE] by Ch [CHRONOMETER] 82 " 58 W.

Remarks [REMARKS] on board Wedns [WEDNESDAY] Oct [OCTOBER] the 16 - 1844

Commences [COMMENCES] with light winds from the SSW heading W by S at 4pm [SARA?] a ship heading in to the S and E at 6pm tacked [???] heading SE by S latter part at 3am had light squalls of rain. Draft the top sails out 6am maid [MADE] land with a ship in [LIGHT?] [???] and in [MENDING?] sail latt [LATITUDE] by Obs

[OBSERVATION] 56 " 09 long [LONGITUDE] by Ch [CHRONOMETER] 82 " 15 W.

Remarks [REMARKS] on board Thirsd [THURSDAY] Oct [OCTOBER] the 17 - 1844

Commences [COMMENCES] with strong winds from the SW heading SSE at 6pm. Draft the top sails latter part at 2am had a gale [GALE] of wind [???] to under double draft to sail and fore sail [???] draft fore top sail heading E by S at 7am [???] ship heading SW [SAW?] ends latter by Obs [OBSERVATION] 06 " 58 S long [LONGITUDE] by Ch [CHRONOMETER] 82 " 33 W

6

7

Remarks On Board Satud [SATURDAY] Novem [NOVEMBER] the 9 - 1844
Commences [COMMENCES] with strong winds and heavy [HEAVY] sea [SEA] from the WNW heading SW by W all [???] in placed in boiling at 6pm finished boiling. Clost reefed the fore and main top sail and [???] latter part at 6am wore [WAR?] ship heading North made [MADE] all prudent in [???] in [COOPERING?] oil low ends latter [LATITUDE] by Obs [OBSERVATION] 42 " 58 S long [LONGITUDE] by Ch [CHRONOMETER] 77 " 50 W.

Remarks [REMARKS] On Board Sund [SUNDAY] Novem [NOVEMBER] the 10 - 1844

Commences [COMMENCES] with strong winds from the WNW heading North at 12 past 2pm wore [WAR?] ship heading SW at 6pm. Shortened sail and [???] latter part at 6am made [MADE?] all prudent sail. At 11am had a gale of wind took in the fore [FORE] and mizen [MIZZEN] topsail. Clost [CLOSE] reefed [REEF] the main low ends latter [LATITUDE] by Obs [OBSERVATION] 43 " 14 S long [LONGITUDE] by Ch [CHRONOMETER] of 8 " 16 W.

Remarks [REMARKS] On Board Mond [MONDAY] Novem [NOVEMBER] the 11 - 1844

Commences [COMMENCES] with a gale of wind from the WNW heading SW at 5pm had the wind from the SW steering [STEERING] W by N had it more moderate soot the fore top sail and [???]
latter part at 6am commenced [COMMENCED] braving out to [???] oil at 9am had a gale of wind took in the fore [FORE] topsail at 12 finished [STOURING?] down low ends latter [LATITUDE] by Obs [OBSERVATION] 42 " 41 S long [LONGITUDE] by Ch [CHRONOMETER] 78 " 20 W.

Remarks [REMARKS] On Board Tuesd [TUESDAY] No [NOVEMBER] the 12 - 1844

Commences [COMMENCES] with strong gail from the SW heading WNW in [???] in ships duty at 4pm had it more moderate and [???]

latter part at 6am steared [STEERED] in to the [???] maid [MADE] all prudant and [???] in [???] in clearing [???] at 11 am saw right whail [WHALE] [???] the boats but did not [???] [SOW?] ends.

latt [LATITUDE]by Obs [OBSERVATION] 41 " 57 S long [LONGITUDE] by CC [CHRONOMETER] 78 " 40 W

8

9

Remarks [REMARKS] On Board Sund [SUNDAY] No [NOVEMBER] the 17 - 1844

Commences [COMMENCES] with over cast [OVERCAST] wether [WEATHER] and a strong breas [BREEZE] from the W heading to the N and W. All hans [HANDS] in ploid [EMPLOYED?] in boiling at 5pm wore [WEAR?] ship heading SSW and [???] latter part had it thick and squalley at 7am had a gail [GALE]of wind heading SW sow ends in boiling latt [LATITUDE] by Obs [OBSERVATION] 41 " 20 S long [LONGITUDE] by Ch [CHRONOMETER] 79 " 9

Remarks [REMARKS] On Board Mond [MONDAY] No [NOVEMBER] the 18 - 1844

Commences [COMMENCES] with a gail [GALE] of wind from the WNW heading SW all hans [HANDS] in ploid [EMPLOYED?] in boiling and [COOPERING?] at 6pm finished boiling heading SW by W

latter part at 2am had thik [THICK] and rainey [RAINY] at 6am had the wind from the SSW wore [WEAR?] ship heading W by N at 11 had it clear and a gail of wind Sow ends latt [LATITUDE] BY OBS [OBSERVATION] 41 " 28 S long [LONGITUDE] by Ch [CHRONOMETER] 79 " 22 W.

Remarks [REMARKS] On Board Tuesd [TUESDAY] No [NOVEMBER] the 19 - 1844

Commences [COMMENCES] with a gail of wind heading NW by W all hans [HANDS] in ploid [EMPLOYED?] stouring [STIRRING?] down oil and [???] at 6pm finished the main hatch way had light winds and over cast [OVERCAST] wether [WEATHER]

[???] 9pm had the wind from the West wore [WEAR?] ship heading SSW latter part at 6am had fine wether [WEATHER] made all prudant sail.

All hans [HANDS] in ploid [EMPLOYED?] in stouring [STIRRING?] down oil. Sow

ends latt [LATITUDE] by Obs [OBSERVATION] 41 " 24 S long [LONGITUDE] by Ch [CHRONOMETER] 79 " 25 W.

Remarks [REMARKS] On Board Wedns [WEDNESDAY] No [NOVEMBER] the 20 - 1844

Commences [COMMENCES] with fine wether [WEATHER] with strong breas [BREEZE] from the WNW heading SW by S. All hans [HANDS] in ploied [EMPLOYED?] in slowing down all at 3pm finished at 6pm shortened sail latter part at 2am had it [SQUALLEY?] at 8am had it more moderate maid [MADE] sail stearing [STEERING] ENE. Sow ends in latt [LATITUDE] 42 " 01 S long [LONGITUDE] by Ch [CHRONOMETER] 79 " 45 W.

10

11

Remarks [REMARKS] On Board Thursd [THURSDAY] Dec [DECEMBER] the 12 - 1844

Commences [COMMENCES] with strong winds from the SW stearing [STEERING] NNW at 5 had hevey [HEAVY] squalls of winds. Clost [CLOSE] reaft [REEF?] the main top sail at [??] [??] the wind heading W by W.

latter part at 7am heading NW by N[??] a reaft [REEF?] mainsail. Sow end in squallery wether [WEATHER] lat [LATITUTDE] by Obs [OBSERVATION] 41 " 52 S long [LONGITUDE] by Ch [CHRONOMETER] 79 " 50 W.

Remarks [REMARKS] On Board Frid [FRIDAY] Dec [DECEMBER] the 19 - 1844

Commences [COMMENCES] with squaley [SQUALLY?] and thik [THICK] wether [WEATHER] with the wind from the WSW heading NW by N at 7pm heading NW. latter part at 7am [??] the foar [FORE?] top sail. Sow end in squalley wether [WEATHER] latt [LATITUDE] by Ob [OBSERVATION] 41 " 18 S long [LONGITUDE] BY CH [CHRONOMETER] 79 " 05 W.

Remarks [REMARKS] On Board Satud [SATURDAY] Dec [DEC] the 14 - 1844

Commences [COMMENCES] with over cast [OVERCAST] wether [WEATHER] with the wind from the W heading SW by S at 6pm heading S wore [WEAR?] ship heading NW and [??]

latter part at 7am wore [WEAR?] ship heading E by S maid [MADE] all prudant sail. Sow ends latt [LATITUDE] by Obs [OBSERVATION] 41 " 08 S long [LONGITUDE] by Ch [CHRONOMETER] 79 " 20 W.

Remarks [REMARKS] On Board Sund [SUNDAY] Dec [DECEMBER] the 15 - 1844

Commences [COMMENCES] with strong winds and clear from the S heading E by S at 7pm wore [WEAR?] ship heading SW shortened sail and [???] heading ENE. latter part at 4am wore [WEAR?] ship at 6am had fine wether [WEATHER] maid [MADE] all sail. Sow ends latt [LATITUDE] by Obs [OBSERVATION] 41 " 12 S long [LONGITUDE] by Ch [CHRONOMETER] 79 " 00 W.

Remarks [REMARKS] On Board Mond [MONDAY] Dec [DECEMBER] the 16 - 1844

Commences [COMMENCES] with fine wether [WEATHER] with the wind from the S by E heading E By S. Saw a dead whail [WHALE] the windward board the boat and found it [???] a dead Sperm whail [WHALE] but to [TOO] much decaed [DECAYED]

Save at 7pm shortened sail wore [WEAR?] ship heading ESW at 6am took in the [COAST?] [???] and [???] cut a [???] maid [MADE] all [???] and [???] ends in black [SWITHERING?] latt [LATITUDE] by Obs [OBSERVATION] 41 " 28 S long [LONGITUDE] BY CH [CHRONOMETER] 78 " 15 W.

12

13

Remarks [REMARKS] On Board Satud [SATURDAY] Dec [DECEMBER] the 21 - 1844

Commences [COMMENCES] with strong winds from the SW steering [STEERING] NW at 6pm had it moderate with the wind from the WSW latter [???] at 4am had it squalley at 6am had fine wether [WEATHER] maid [MADE] sail steering [STEERING] NE [???] sow ends latt [LATITUDE] by Obs [OBSERVATION] 39 " [???] long [LONGITUDE] by Ch [CHRONOMETER] 79 " 30 W.

Remarks [REMARKS] On Board Sund [SUNDAY] Dec [DECEMBER] the 22 - 1844

Commences [COMMENCES] with strong winds from the NW steering [STEERING] NE by W under all drawing sail at 7pm shortened sail [???] to the wind heading N B E at 11pm wore [WEAR?] ship heading W by S. latter part at 6am wore [WEAR?] ship heading NE by S at 8am had strong winds and thik [THICK] and over cast [OVERCAST] shortened sail sow latt by Obs [OBSERVATION] 39 " 45 S long [LONGITUDE] by Ch [CHRONOMETER] 78 " 25 [???]

Remarks [REMARKS] On Board Mond [MONDAY] Dec [DECEMBER] the 23 - 1844

Commences [COMMENCES] with strong winds and thik [THICK] and rainy with the wind from the NW heading NE by N at [???] past 1pm. Saw a mirchant

[MERCHANT] [BOAT?] steering [STEERING] in to the E and S at 2 had the wind from the W heading N [???] W at 4pm had light winds at 10pm wore [WEAR?] ship heading SW

latter part at 3am wore [WEAR?] ship heading WNW at 6am maid [MADE] all prudent sail steering [STEERING] NW by N. Sow ends latt [LATITUDE] by Obs [OBSERVATION] 38 " 09 S long [LONGITUDE] by Ch [CHRONOMETER] 78 " 20 W.

Remarks [REMARKS] On Board Tuesd [TUESDAY] Dec [DECEMBER] the 24 - 1844

Commences [COMMENCES] with fine wether [WEATHER] steering [STEERING] NW with the wind from the WSW in ploied [EMPLOYED?] in [RING?] [RATLING?] [ROAP?] at 7pm shortened [???] [COFED?] to the wind heading SW by W

latter part at 6am maid [MADE] all prudent sail [???] WNW at 7am had light winds at 8. Saw blackfish. Sow ends latt [LATITUDE] by Obs [OBSERVATION] 34 " 20 S long [LONGITUDE] by Ch [CHRONOMETER] 78 " 49 W.

14

15

[STEMAR?] On Board

latter port at 6am maid [MADE] all sail steering [STEERING] N NW at 10am. Saw massafuero baring [BEARING] W by SW by compas [COMPASS]. Low ends latt [LATITUDE] by Obs [OBSERVATION] 34 " 45 S long [LONGITUDE] by Ch [CHRONOMETER] 81 " 5.

Remarks [REMARKS] On Board Mond [MONDAY] Dec [DECEMBER] the 30 - 1844

Commences [COMMENCES] with fine wether [WEATHER] steering [STEERING] NW by [N?] with the Island of Massafuero in light baring [BEARING] N by W at 6pm. Shortened sail [LEFED?] to the wind heading W by N with the island 30 mills [MILES] dist [DISTANCE] latter part at 4am steared [STEERED] of for the island. Maid [MADE] all sail had it over cast [OVERCAST] and light shows [SHOWERS] of rain low end with the Island of Massafuero baring [BEARING] SE 10 mills [MILES] past.

Remarks [REMARKS] On Board Tuesd [TUESDAY] Dec [DECEMBER] the 31 - 1844

Commences [COMMENCES] with light squall SW laying of an [ON?] at Massafuero with 2 boats in after wavd [WAVED?] at so [???] [CARRIE?] a long tide with 2 load

shortened sail steering [STEERING] WNW and S
latter part at 8am saw a ship to the SW of us at 10am tacked ship heading SSW. Low
ends latt [LATITUDE] by Obs [OBSERVATION] 33 " 18 S long [LONGITUDE] by
[RECK?] 81 " 10 W

Remarks [REMARKS] On Board Wedns [WEDNESDAY] January the 1 - 1845
Commences [COMMENCES] with fine wether [WEATHER] with the wind from the
S and W at 1pm tacked ship heading W and S at 4pm. Spok the book Mary Frasier of
New Bedford at 6pm. Spok the [OBID?] wicked wore [WEAR] ship heading SW
latter part had over cast [OVERCAST] wether [WEATHER]. Low ends latt
[LATITUDE] by [RECK?] 33 " 35 S long [LONGITUDE] by [RECK] 81 " 0 W.

Remarks [REMARKS] On Board Thursd [THURSDAY] January the 2 - 1845
Commences [COMMENCES] with over cast [OVERCAST] wether [WEATHER]
with the wind from the SSE heading SW at 6pm. Spok [SPOKE?] the ship [OBID?]
michel shortened sail and [???]
latter part at 6am maid [MADE] all sail heading SW with the ship [OBID?] michael in
sight. Low ends latt [LATITUDE] by Obs [OBSERVATION] 33 " 45 S long
[LONGITUDE]
by Ch [CHRONOMETER] [24?] " [20?] W.

16

17

Remarks [REMARKS] On Board Tuesd [TUESDAY] January the 4 - 1845
Commences [COMMENCES] with a light breas [BREEZE] from the EN heading off
in ploied [EMPLOYED?] in boiling at 8pm had it calm and [???] latter part at 4am
finished boiling at 7am maid [MADE] all prudant sail at 11am saw a lark heading to
the S and E low end steering [STEERING] SW by W latt [LATITUDE] by Obs
[OBSERVATION] 34 " 09 S long [LONGITUDE] by Ch [CHRONOMETER] 84 "
55 W.

Remarks [REMARKS] On Board Wedns [WEDNESDAY] January the 8 - 1845
Commences [COMMENCES] with fine wether [WEATHER] steering [STEERING]
SW at 2pm. Saw a whail [WHALE] to the WNW steared [STEERED] of for him
called him a finback at 7pm shortened sail [LOFED?] to the wind heading ESW latter
part at pm maid [MADE] all sail steering [STEERING] WSW in ploied
[EMPLOYED?] in coopering oil low ends latt [LATITUDE] 34 " 10 S long
[LONGITUDE] by Ch [CHRONOMETER] 56 " 10 W

Remarks [REMARKS] On Board Thirsd [THURSDAY] January the 9 -1845
Commences [COMMENCES] with light winds from the SE steering [STEERING]
WSW at 3pm. Saw a Spirm [SPERM] whail [WHALE] loard [LOWERED] the boats
at 6 had him long side shortened sail heading W by E
latter part at 5pm [WHALE ILLUSTRATION]
Comminced [COMMENCED] cutting. Low ends latt [LATITUDE] by Obs
[OBSERVATION] 34 " 04 S long [LONGITUDE] by reckening [RECKONING] 86 "
05 W.

Remarks [REMARKS] On Board Frid [FRIDAY] January the 10 - 1845
Commences [COMMENCES] with a calm all hans [HANDS] in ploied
[EMPLOYED?] in cutting at [???] past 2 finished at 4 [???] [SAILING?] and [???]
latter part at 7am maid [MADE] sail low ends latt [LATITUDE] by Obs
[OBSERVATION] 24 " 01 S long [LONGITUDE] by Ch [CHRONOMETER] 87 "
00 W.

Remarks [REMARKS] On Board Satud [SATURDAY] January the 11 - 1845
Commences [COMMENCES] with light winds from the NW [HEADING?] WSW in
ploied [EMPLOYED?] in boiling at 7pm [???] sail laying with the main yard [???]
latter part at 6am maid [MADE] sail
11am wore [WEAR] ship heading ENE low ends sailing latt [LATITUDE] by Obs
[OBSERVATION] 34 " 11 S long [LONGITUDE] by Ch [CHRONOMETER] 87 " 12
W.

18

19

1824 Sales of oil at Retale [RETAIL?]
Jany [JANUARY?] [ILLUSTRATION OF 5 TICK MARKS] gallons
half gallons [ILLUSTRATION OF 1 TICK MARK]

20

[BACK OF LOG BOOK WITH VARIOUS WRITING]

Noil

1h40 1/2

32

3280

4920

16

52496
1667

41.63
1.63

34000

1'110

1 /0

This transcription was made possible thanks to JTak, Katie, LDeWilde, and Robin.

Log 115, Log of the ship Martha, in the Ships' Logs Collection, Nantucket Historical Association.